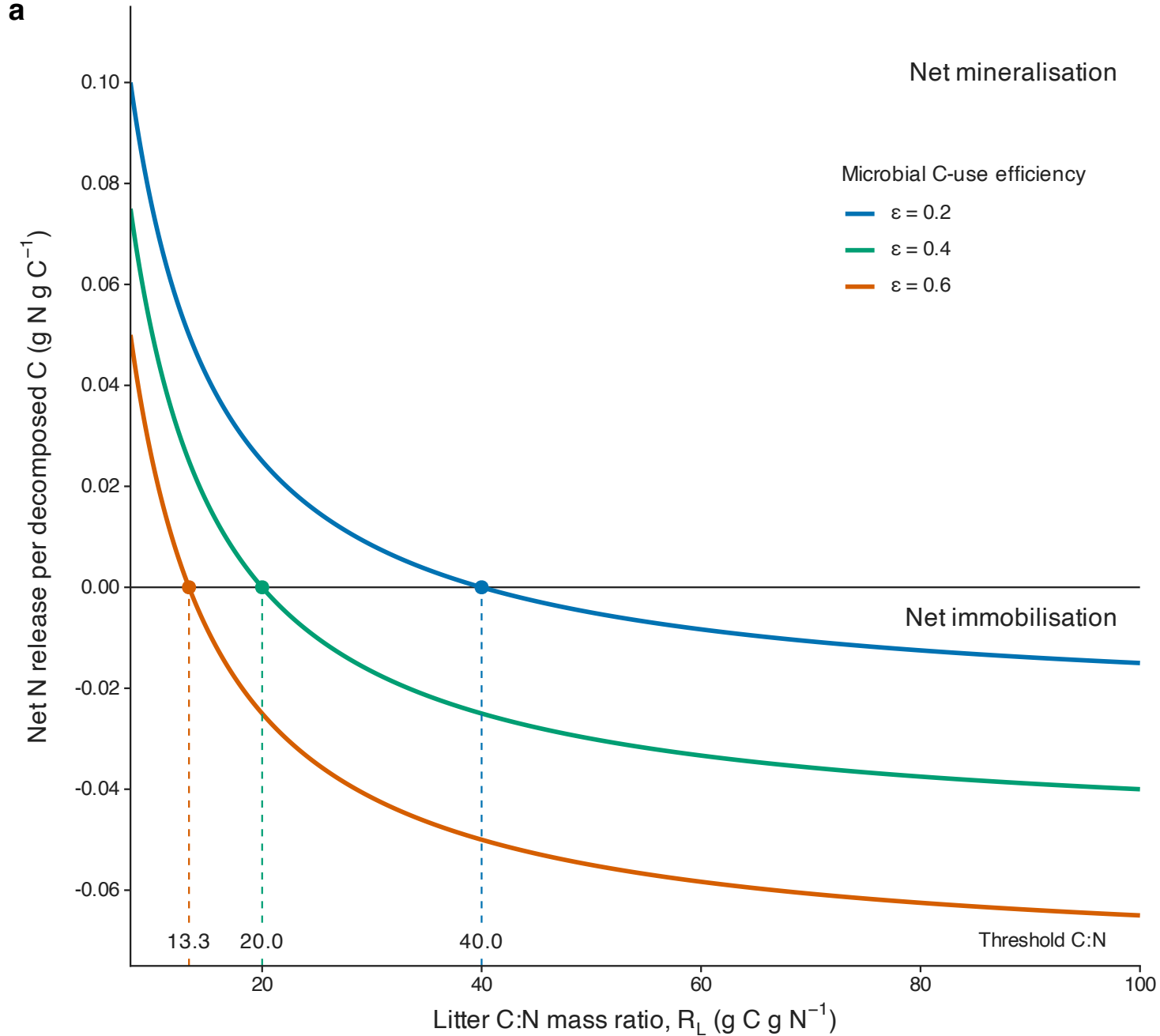


a**b**Decomposed litter carbon: D N supplied by litter: D/R_L New microbial carbon: εD Microbial N demand: $\varepsilon D/R_B$

$$\frac{M_N}{D} = \frac{1}{R_L} - \frac{\varepsilon}{R_B}$$

Zero net release when $R_L = R_B/\varepsilon$

Here microbial C:N is fixed:

$$R_B = 8 \text{ g C g N}^{-1}$$